Structures & forces

National 5 · Mechanisms & structures · Worksheet

ENGINEERING WITH MR KELLY

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

By the end of this worksheet I can…

- ☐ identify tension and compression and types of load
- ☐ draw free body diagrams and apply the conditions of equilibrium
- ☐ use the principle of moments to find reaction forces

I DO — Worked example

Read how a full-mark answer is built

A 5 m beam is simply supported at A and B. Loads of 600 N at 1.5 m and 900 N at 3.75 m from A.

1 Calculate the reactions RA and RB. (4 marks)

Full-mark answer each ✓ is one mark

Take moments about A: (600 × 1.5) + (900 × 3.75) = RB × 5 ✓. RB = 4275 ÷ 5 = 855 N ✓. Upward = downward forces: RA + 855 = 1500 ✓, so RA = 645 N ✓.

Why answers lose marks

"RA = RB = 1500 ÷ 2 = 750 N"

0 marks: the loads aren't symmetrical, so moments must be taken.

WE DO — Guided practice

Use the starters and word bank to help you

Members in a bridge truss are in tension or compression.

2 State what is meant by a member in tension. (1 mark)

Sentence starters

1. …

Word bank

pulled · member · forces · stretched

Tip: 1 marks = 1 separate, developed points.

YOU DO — On your own

No notes. Check your answers afterwards.

3 Quick check: tick one box for each.

a) For a beam in equilibrium, which is true?

☐ CWM > ACWM ☐ CWM = ACWM ☐ Upward > downward ☐ No forces act

b) A 200 N force acts 0.5 m from a pivot. The moment is…

☐ 100 N m ☐ 400 N m ☐ 200.5 N m ☐ 0.0025 N m

c) A member being squashed is a…

☐ Tie ☐ Strut ☐ Beam ☐ Cable

d) Loads of 650 N and 890 N are supported by RA and a 560 N force. RA is…
☐ 980 N ☐ 1540 N ☐ 560 N ☐ 330 N

4 Key terms: write the letter of the matching description next to each term.

1. **Tie**	____	**A** Upward forces = downward forces (ΣFv = 0).
2. **Strut**	____	**B** Force × perpendicular distance from the pivot.
3. **Moment**	____	**C** A member in tension.
4. **Principle of moments**	____	**D** Sum of clockwise moments = sum of anticlockwise moments.
5. **Vertical equilibrium**	____	**E** A member in compression.

A sign hangs from a bracket.

5 State the two conditions of equilibrium. (2 marks)

6 Explain what is meant by ‘Free body diagram’. (2 marks)

7 Explain what is meant by ‘Concurrent forces’. (2 marks)

Check and reflect
Mark your answers with the answer sheet. Go back to the checklist on the site and re-rate each “I can” statement above. Which one still needs work?